

UNILEVER SOUTH AFRICA

COMMERCIAL OPPORTUNITY PULSE

Top 3 opportunities identified from current POS evidence

POS period 2026-08-16 · 4 POS weeks · Ranking: Commercial Brain V1

Distribution gaps — led by Shoprite — are the clearest near-term growth opportunity

Three high-confidence distribution gaps represent R9.9k of addressable value and 211 units across priority SKU-retailer-region combinations.

Commercial implication. Prioritize distribution expansion before increasing promotional spend where availability is the primary constraint.

ADDRESSABLE OPPORTUNITY ESTIMATE	ADDRESSABLE VOLUME	DOMINANT LEVER
R9,897	211 units	DISTRIBUTION

Sum of the three Commercial Brain opportunities. This is an addressable opportunity estimate, not guaranteed incremental sales.

TOP 3 OPPORTUNITIES

Rank	Product	Retailer	Region	Lever	Opportunity	Confidence
1	Sunlight Pine Gel 500ml	Shoprite	Free State	DISTRIBUTION	R4,534	HIGH
2	Sunlight Pine Gel 1l	Shoprite	Gauteng	DISTRIBUTION	R2,710	HIGH
3	Handy Andy All Purpose Cleaner Eucalyptus 5l	Makro Online	Gauteng	DISTRIBUTION	R2,653	HIGH

Addressable value by Brain rank

#1 Sunlight Pine Gel 500ml	R4,534
#2 Sunlight Pine Gel 1l	R2,710
#3 Handy Andy All Purpose Cleaner Eucalyptus 5l	R2,653

Commercial Brain rank order. Values are addressable opportunity estimates.

SUPPORTING MACRO CONTEXT

Consumer pressure increasing · FNB/BER CCI = -19

Macro context is supporting background only. It does not cause or recalculate POS opportunities.

SOCIAL INTELLIGENCE

Social intelligence: LIVE — GDELT. 67 normalised public-web observations (54 analysed). Brands detected: Sunlight. Sentiment label NEUTRAL (observation, not a sales driver). Observation window 2026-06-02T13:17:18Z to 2026-08-31T13:17:18Z.

Supporting context only. Social observations do not cause POS gaps and are not commercial actions.

Source: Commercial Brain V1 (backend/data/brain_reports/New Discovery_2026-08-27 (3).brain.json). Narrative: Storytelling Engine V1. Causality claim: none.

OPPORTUNITY 1 · DISTRIBUTION · HIGH

Expand distribution of Sunlight Pine Gel 500ml in Free State

Sunlight Pine Gel 500ml · Sunlight · Shoprite · Free State

CURRENT SALES	ADDRESSABLE VALUE	ADDRESSABLE VOLUME	CONFIDENCE
R189	R4,534	84.0	HIGH

Commercial evidence

Store gap: 24 · Current stores: 1 · Benchmark stores: 25 · Value/store: R189 · Volume/store: 3.5

Store coverage vs benchmark

#1 listed 1 vs benchmark 25



Listed stores versus like-for-like benchmark. Gap-closing value is addressable, not booked sales.

Current sales vs addressable opportunity



Current sales are distinct from addressable opportunity and are not incremental sales.

Why this matters

Listed-store economics are attractive while coverage sits 24 stores below the like-for-like benchmark at Shoprite in Free State. Addressable value and addressable volume equal value/store and volume/store times that store gap; they are not guaranteed incremental sales. Current sales are separate. Price or promotion is not the first lever: low coverage is limiting reach. Evidence is stronger than the rest of this short panel, but this remains addressable opportunity, not guaranteed incremental sales.

Recommended action

Brief a distribution expansion for Sunlight Pine Gel 500ml at Shoprite in Free State: close a 24-store gap toward 25 stores. Do not lead with a price cut because sales are low.

Supporting evidence

- Distribution addressable value = value/store 188.93 x store gap 24.0 = R4,534; addressable volume = volume/store 3.5 x store gap 24.0 = 84.0 units. This is the gap-closing opportunity, not guaranteed incremental sales.
- Frozen Distribution Agent value R4,534 / 84.0 units (confidence HIGH); the Brain does not re-score it.
- Primary-lever addressable value R4,534 / 84.0 units (gross specialist total R4,534 was not used).
- Current sales R189 (distinct from addressable value; not the opportunity).
- Double-counting risk: NONE.

Risks / limitations

Double-counting risk: NONE. Addressable value is not guaranteed incremental sales.

- Reported value is the primary lever only; specialist estimates are not summed.
- Estimates are directional and are not guaranteed incremental sales.

Source / provenance

Agent: Commercial Brain V1. Specialist: Distribution Agent V1. Source: backend/data/brain_reports/New Discovery_2026-08-27 (3).brain.json. Observation date: 2026-08-16.

OPPORTUNITY 2 · DISTRIBUTION · HIGH

Expand distribution of Sunlight Pine Gel 1l in Gauteng

Sunlight Pine Gel 1l · Sunlight · Shoprite · Gauteng

CURRENT SALES	ADDRESSABLE VALUE	ADDRESSABLE VOLUME	CONFIDENCE
R31,684	R2,710	54.2	HIGH

Commercial evidence

Store gap: 13 · Current stores: 152 · Benchmark stores: 165 · Value/store: R208 · Volume/store: 4.2

Store coverage vs benchmark

#2 listed 152 vs benchmark 165



Listed stores versus like-for-like benchmark. Gap-closing value is addressable, not booked sales.

Current sales vs addressable opportunity



Current sales are distinct from addressable opportunity and are not incremental sales.

Why this matters

Listed-store economics are attractive while coverage sits 13 stores below the like-for-like benchmark at Shoprite in Gauteng. Addressable value and addressable volume equal value/store and volume/store times that store gap; they are not guaranteed incremental sales. Current sales are separate. Price or promotion is not the first lever: low coverage is limiting reach. Evidence is stronger than the rest of this short panel, but this remains addressable opportunity, not guaranteed incremental sales.

Recommended action

Brief a distribution expansion for Sunlight Pine Gel 1l at Shoprite in Gauteng: close a 13-store gap toward 165 stores. Do not lead with a price cut because sales are low.

Supporting evidence

- Distribution addressable value = value/store 208.4493 x store gap 13.0 = R2,710; addressable volume = volume/store 4.1711 x store gap 13.0 = 54.2 units. This is the gap-closing opportunity, not guaranteed incremental sales.
- Frozen Distribution Agent value R2,710 / 54.2 units (confidence HIGH); the Brain does not re-score it.
- Primary-lever addressable value R2,710 / 54.2 units (gross specialist total R2,710 was not used).
- Current sales R31,684 (distinct from addressable value; not the opportunity).
- Double-counting risk: NONE.

Risks / limitations

Double-counting risk: NONE. Addressable value is not guaranteed incremental sales.

- Reported value is the primary lever only; specialist estimates are not summed.
- Estimates are directional and are not guaranteed incremental sales.

Source / provenance

Agent: Commercial Brain V1. Specialist: Distribution Agent V1. Source: backend/data/brain_reports/New Discovery_2026-08-27 (3).brain.json. Observation date: 2026-08-16.

OPPORTUNITY 3 · DISTRIBUTION · HIGH

Expand distribution of Handy Andy All Purpose Cleaner Eucalyptus 5l in Gauteng

Handy Andy All Purpose Cleaner Eucalyptus 5l · Handy Andy · Makro Online · Gauteng

CURRENT SALES	ADDRESSABLE VALUE	ADDRESSABLE VOLUME	CONFIDENCE
R7,076	R2,653	73.1	HIGH

Commercial evidence

Store gap: 3 · Current stores: 8 · Benchmark stores: 11 · Value/store: R884 · Volume/store: 24.4

Store coverage vs benchmark

#3 listed 8 vs benchmark 11



Listed stores versus like-for-like benchmark. Gap-closing value is addressable, not booked sales.

Current sales vs addressable opportunity



Current sales are distinct from addressable opportunity and are not incremental sales.

Why this matters

Listed-store economics are attractive while coverage sits 3 stores below the like-for-like benchmark at Makro Online in Gauteng. Addressable value and addressable volume equal value/store and volume/store times that store gap; they are not guaranteed incremental sales. Current sales are separate. Price or promotion is not the first lever: low coverage is limiting reach. Evidence is stronger than the rest of this short panel, but this remains addressable opportunity, not guaranteed incremental sales.

Recommended action

Brief a distribution expansion for Handy Andy All Purpose Cleaner Eucalyptus 5l at Makro Online in Gauteng: close a 3-store gap toward 11 stores. Do not lead with a price cut because sales are low.

Supporting evidence

- Distribution addressable value = value/store 884.4412 x store gap 3.0 = R2,653; addressable volume = volume/store 24.375 x store gap 3.0 = 73.1 units. This is the gap-closing opportunity, not guaranteed incremental sales.
- Frozen Distribution Agent value R2,653 / 73.1 units (confidence HIGH); the Brain does not re-score it.
- Primary-lever addressable value R2,653 / 73.1 units (gross specialist total R2,653 was not used).
- Current sales R7,076 (distinct from addressable value; not the opportunity).
- Double-counting risk: NONE.

Risks / limitations

Double-counting risk: NONE. Addressable value is not guaranteed incremental sales.

- Reported value is the primary lever only; specialist estimates are not summed.
- Estimates are directional and are not guaranteed incremental sales.

Source / provenance

Agent: Commercial Brain V1. Specialist: Distribution Agent V1. Source: backend/data/brain_reports/New Discovery_2026-08-27 (3).brain.json. Observation date: 2026-08-16.

METHODOLOGY AND LIMITATIONS

How to read this pulse

Based on current POS data and identified commercial gaps. Addressable opportunity is directional and not guaranteed incremental sales.

Coverage

POS period: 2026-08-16. POS weeks: 4.

Price/promotion weeks: 3. SKU identity: product name (ProductsID is not the canonical join key).

Limitations

- Opportunity PDF V1 is a presentation layer. It copies Commercial Brain ranking and does not rescore specialists.
- POS data period: 2026-08-16.
- POS weeks available: 4.
- Price/promotion weeks: 3.
- Addressable opportunity estimates are directional and are not guaranteed incremental sales.
- No causal incrementality claim is made.
- Social intelligence: LIVE — GDELT
- Macro context is supporting background only and does not change Commercial Brain ranking.
- Storytelling Engine V1 consumes Commercial Brain one-slide output only.
- Specialist and Commercial Brain opportunity values are not recalculated.
- Confidence is copied from the Commercial Brain and is never upgraded.
- Addressable value and addressable volume are not guaranteed incremental sales.
- No capture rate is introduced by the Storytelling Engine.
- Dashboard and PDF layers are not built in this sprint.
- Frozen macro context is supporting background only and is attached only when it supports the POS story.
- Macro HIGH confidence is the label on the frozen signal; it does not upgrade POS or Commercial Brain confidence.
- Macro context is not a causal explanation of POS gaps.
- Addressable opportunity remains not guaranteed incremental sales.

Provenance

- brain: backend/data/brain_reports/New Discovery_2026-08-27 (3).brain.json
- storytelling: backend/data/storytelling_reports/storytelling_v1_one_slide.json
- distribution: backend/data/distribution_reports/New Discovery_2026-08-27 (3).distribution.json
- price: backend/data/price_reports/New Discovery_2026-08-27 (3).price.json
- promotion: backend/data/promotion_reports/New Discovery_2026-08-27 (3).promotion.json
- integrated: backend/data/integrated/New Discovery_2026-08-27 (3).commercial.csv
- macro: backend/data/macro_context/macro_context_v1.json
- ranking: Commercial Brain V1 top_actions (copied, not re-ranked)

The JSON report is the source of truth. This PDF copies those values and does not recalculate Commercial Brain ranking, specialist scores, or confidence.